

Hangzhou First Applied Material (603806.SS)

2Q26 mixed with lower volume and higher margin; PCB guidance raised; reiterate Buy

HZ First reported 2Q26 EBITDA of RMB 681mn, representing a 55% increase QoQ and 78% YoY. This remains 13% below our estimate (GSe) of RMB 783mn, primarily due to softer solar film shipments, which declined 14% QoQ to 565mn sqm (vs. GSe of +15% QoQ and a +2% QoQ increase in global module production to 123GW). The volume shortfall was partially offset by stronger-than-expected GPM, which reached 20% in 2Q (+6pp QoQ), exceeding our estimate of 15%.

During result briefing, **Management provided guidance for i) solar film shipments to grow 30%/20% qoq in 3Q26 and 4Q26, with GPM target to remain stable at 20%; and ii) DFR film business to see continued volume growth (+30% YoY in 2026-2027) and margin expansion (exceeding 33%).**

Solar Film: Improving volume and stable margin outlook in 2H26: Despite the 14% QoQ dip in 2Q26 shipments, Management reaffirmed their FY25 shipment target unchanged at 2.8 billion sqm (flat yoy). Specifically, Management mentioned strong order flow in Aug and that they expect 3Q shipments to reach 20-30% qoq. As a cross-check, monthly average global module production in July-Aug is already up by 17% qoq, as per Oilchem and SMM. Given the recovery trend in September, we project solar film shipments to grow 30% in 3Q and 20% in 4Q. On margin, 2Q segment GPM rose to 20% (vs. 14% in 1Q) due to energy-driven resin price hikes. Management aims to sustain GPM at this level by increasing the mix of high-margin overseas shipments (targeting 30-40% of total volume in 2026, up from 20% in 2025) and focusing on emerging packaging technologies (e.g., low-silver tech), which carries a 5-10pp premium over conventional products.

PCB Packaging: robust profitability outlook driven by high-end product penetration and continued customer expansion: DFR shipments grew 10% QoQ in 2Q26 to 57mn sqm, with GPM expanding significantly to 33% (vs. 25% in 1Q). Management noted that the current 72% utilization rate (up from 66% in 1Q) represents near-full capacity due to production losses associated with diverse product specifications.

Looking forward, Management expects continued qoq shipment growth in 2H26 and reiterated at least 30% YoY growth target for 2026/2027, driven by capacity expansion (2mn sqm scheduled to launch in 2H26) and broader capacity expansion growth among Chinese PCB players. Meanwhile, Management also highlighted their

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global volume share target to rise from 10% in 2025 to 30% within three years. On margin, Management guided for continued expansion in 2H26 from 33% in 2Q26, mainly driven by scale benefit and rising high-end product mix (target to increase high-end HDI shipment mix from 10% in 2025 to 20-30% in 2026 and 40%-50% in 2027).

Management also mentioned their on-track progress for key customer expansion in 2Q26 and noted:

- **Shennan Circuits:** HZ First remains the primary supplier for the full PCB packaging range, holding over 50% of the total procurement share.
- **Victory Giant:** Deliveries began in April, specifically for AI server HDI film. While current volumes remain small, shipments have trended upward over the past two months.

Earnings revision and valuation: Post results, we slightly increase Hangzhou First's EBITDA by average 1% in 2026E-2030E to reflect the stronger PCB margin guidance. Accordingly, our 12m target price moves to Rmb 21 (vs. prior Rmb20), still based on 17X 2027E EV/EBITDA discounted back to 2026E at a 10.7% CoE. Reiterate Buy, as we believe the improving profitability outlook will continue driving valuation upside.

Exhibit 1: HZ First's 2Q26 results comparison

Rmb mn	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	yoy %	qoq %	Prior GSe	Diff
Revenue	3,624	4,334	3,829	3,703	3,373	3,615	-17%	7%	6,081	-41%
Gross profit	475	492	340	390	466	725	47%	56%	888	-18%
EBITDA	392	384	231	313	439	681	77%	55%	783	-13%
Net profit	401	95	192	82	312	530	461%	70%	558	-5%
GPM (%)	13%	11%	9%	11%	14%	20%	9pp	6pp	15%	5pp
SG&A as % of revenue	5%	5%	6%	5%	6%	6%	1pp	0pp	4%	1pp
EBITDA margin (%)	11%	9%	6%	8%	13%	19%	10pp	6pp	13%	6pp
NPM (%)	11%	2%	5%	2%	9%	15%	12pp	5pp	9%	5pp

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Investment thesis, TP methodology and risks

Investment thesis: HZ First is the largest solar film producer globally, with over 50% share of the global solar film industry. We are Buy rated on the stock as we believe HZ First is well positioned to see an earlier and greater profitability inflection across our coverage, driven by a steeper solar film cost curve and earlier marginal capacity exit, while also expecting its structurally growing electrical film businesses to cushion against headwinds in the solar industry.

TP methodology: Our 12m TP of Rmb21 for HZ First is based on a 17X 2027E EV/EBITDA discounted back to 2026E at a 10.7% CoE.

Key risks: 1) Lower-than-expected solar installation leading to lower capacity utilization and lower solar film ASP; 2) slower-than-expected capacity expansion; 3) slower-than-expected development into high-end non-solar business (e.g. AI-PCB, solid state battery packaging, etc.); 4) More intensified raw material procurement (e.g. resin) due to supply disruption.

Exhibit 2:

603806.SS	12m Price Target: Rmb21	Price: Rmb15.16	Upside: 38.5%			
Buy	GS Forecast					
		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	
	Market cap: Rmb39.5bn / \$5.9bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	15,490.8	15,639.2	17,777.3	21,313.6
	Enterprise value: Rmb38.1bn / \$5.7bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	15,490.8	19,771.8	22,732.9	25,668.7
	3m ADTV :Rmb694.2mn/ \$102.5mn	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	1,319.7	2,759.7	3,640.7	5,292.5
	China	EPS (Rmb) New	0.30	0.77	1.03	1.58
	China Clean Energy & Technology	EPS (Rmb) Old	0.30	0.72	0.99	1.55
		P/E (X)	47.8	19.8	14.8	9.6
	M&A Rank: 3	P/B (X)	2.2	2.2	2.0	1.7
	Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	Dividend yield (%)	8.9	1.3	1.7	2.6
		CROCI (%)	7.8	15.1	18.7	25.3
			6/26	9/26E	12/26E	E
	EPS (Rmb)	0.20	0.18	0.26	--	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 19 Aug 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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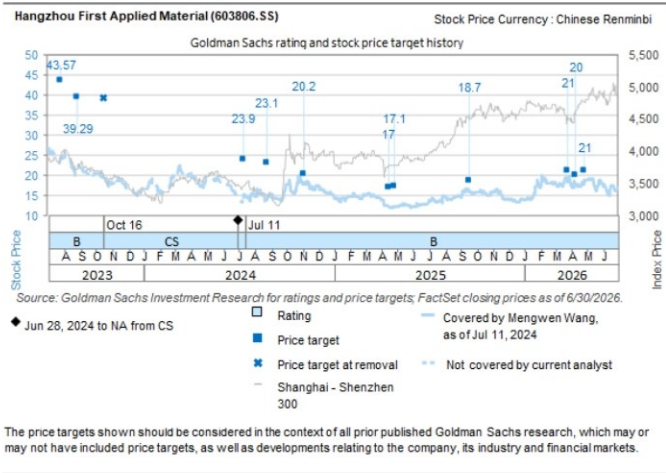
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

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Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
26-Jul-26	20.00	13.75
27-Apr-26	21.00	18.90
09-Apr-26	20.00	17.73
25-Mar-26	21.00	18.79
18-Sep-25	18.70	15.71
28-Apr-25	17.10	12.29
15-Apr-25	17.00	12.28
04-Nov-24	20.20	17.63
26-Aug-24	23.10	14.06
11-Jul-24	23.90	14.50
28-Aug-23	55.00	22.59

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